

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/XDR | Detection Engineering | KQL | SOAR
Automation | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) engineering across large enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender (including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint / MDE, Microsoft Defender for Identity / MDI, and Microsoft 365 Defender), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), and Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection analytics. I have deep expertise in Detection Engineering, Detection-as-Code methodologies, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, cloud security, and threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework. Through PowerShell scripting and SOAR automation I build scalable, repeatable detection and response capabilities that reduce alert fatigue and improve mean time to respond. I am seeking a remote-first Senior Security Engineer role where I can deliver high-quality detection engineering and XDR operations for a leading technology organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection analytics, log ingestion, data connectors, and workbook reporting
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Detection Engineering:** Detection rule authoring and tuning, Detection-as-Code principles, analytic query development in KQL, use-case design against MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs), false-positive reduction
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Automated playbook development in Microsoft Sentinel, SOAR alert triage workflows, automated incident enrichment, ticket creation, and containment actions
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory / Azure AD), Conditional Access, cloud telemetry ingestion and analysis, cloud workload protection
- **Threat Hunting and Incident Response:** Proactive threat hunting via KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK-based adversary mapping, post-incident review and lessons-learned
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook logic, API-based integrations for security orchestration workflows
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Operating Systems and Platforms:** Windows (server and endpoint), Linux (server administration and log analysis)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detections, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytic rules, scheduled queries, and watchlists that surface high-fidelity alerts across cloud, endpoint, identity, and network telemetry sources

- Apply Detection-as-Code principles to manage detection logic systematically, version-controlling KQL queries and mapping each detection to the relevant MITRE ATT&CK Tactic or Technique for full coverage transparency
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage workflows including enrichment from threat intelligence feeds, user risk scoring, and automated containment via Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) response actions
- Administer and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, writing advanced threat-hunting queries to identify adversary behaviours across the estate
- Deploy, configure, and manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user environment, covering Windows and Linux endpoints and providing XDR-level telemetry for detection and response
- Lead proactive threat hunting campaigns using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, investigating anomalous telemetry patterns and mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs)
- Manage cloud security posture in Microsoft Azure and Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory / Azure AD), reviewing Conditional Access policies, monitoring identity-based threats via Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and enforcing least-privilege access controls
- Develop and maintain PowerShell automation scripts that integrate security tools via application programming interfaces (APIs), reducing manual analyst effort for repetitive investigation and response tasks
- Conduct vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), converting scan telemetry into prioritised remediation workstreams tracked to closure
- Lead incident response following NIST 800-61 lifecycle procedures, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review activities in collaboration with infrastructure and application teams
- Contribute to continuous improvement of detection coverage, reviewing alert fidelity metrics, retiring low-value rules, and developing new detections to address emerging threats identified through threat intelligence

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged SIEM alerts from Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, investigating phishing reports, malware detections, lateral movement indicators, and suspicious authentication telemetry on Windows and Linux systems
- Authored and refined Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel to improve signal quality, reducing false-positive rates while maintaining detection coverage for high-priority threat categories
- Supported the rollout of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the Microsoft 365 environment, establishing alert policies and baseline detection configurations
- Developed SOAR-aligned response runbooks and playbooks for common alert types, standardising analyst response steps and accelerating incident resolution
- Performed vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus across Windows and Linux server estates, producing risk-rated remediation reports for infrastructure owners
- Administered Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcements, and user provisioning workflows, supporting identity-based detection and access governance
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, querying endpoint telemetry to identify indicators of compromise and previously undetected persistence mechanisms
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) for administrative credential governance, providing session recording and enforcing least-privilege principles across the infrastructure estate

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed endpoint security controls across a cloud-first Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech platform, deploying and maintaining antivirus, endpoint compliance baselines, and patch management for Windows and Linux systems

- Administered identity and access management including Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) for cloud-hosted business applications, enforcing least-privilege access principles
- Conducted vulnerability assessments across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, producing risk-rated findings and tracking remediation activities to closure
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities, maintaining security documentation and contributing to internal audits and policy reviews
- Developed and maintained automation scripts in PowerShell for routine security and infrastructure management tasks, reducing manual effort across the operations team

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection library using Kusto Query Language (KQL), applying Detection-as-Code principles to map coverage against the MITRE ATT&CK framework and close critical detection gaps across cloud, identity, and endpoint telemetry
- Built and deployed Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating tier-1 alert triage and threat containment workflows, reducing mean time to respond to high-severity incidents
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users at University of the Arts London, establishing full XDR visibility and improving detection fidelity for identity-based and endpoint-based attack paths
- Led proactive threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, uncovering previously undetected adversary activity and translating findings into permanent detection rule improvements
- Optimised CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) policies, achieving measurable reductions in alert volume through intelligent tuning while maintaining detection coverage for high-priority threat categories

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (United Kingdom)